Remote Work and Data Handling Policy

Practical rules for locations, information classification, storage, sharing, and retention

Owner	People Operations	**Version**	3.1
Effective	15 Aug 2026	**Classification**	Internal

1. Remote-work operating model

Contoso Systems supports flexible work when service quality, security, and customer commitments remain protected.

1.1 Eligibility

- Employees may work remotely up to three days per week with manager approval.
- New employees complete their first two weeks from an office unless an exception is approved.
- Contractors follow the work-location terms stated in the contract.
- Roles handling Restricted customer data may have additional location controls.

1.2 Minimum workspace requirements

Area	Requirement
Connectivity	Stable connection suitable for video and secure access.
Privacy	A workspace where confidential conversations cannot be overheard.
Equipment	Company-managed device for Internal or Restricted information.
Availability	Calendar and presence information must reflect working hours.

Related control: Remote access must also meet SEC-114 identity and device requirements.

2. Information classification and sharing

The classification determines where information may be stored, who may receive it, and how it may be shared.

2.1 Classification guide

Classification	Example	Approved handling
Public	Published product brochure	May be shared externally.
Internal	Team procedures	Store in approved company services.
Confidential	Customer contract	Share only with named business participants.
Restricted	Payment or identity data	Use approved restricted repository; external sharing blocked.

2.2 File-sharing rules

- Verify recipients before sharing a link.
- Use view-only access unless editing is required.
- Set an expiry date for external links.
- Do not upload Confidential or Restricted files to personal cloud storage.
- Remove access when a project or contract ends.

Important distinction: A document label guides handling, but access control still must be enforced by the storage and retrieval system.

3. Retention, reporting, and examples

Information should be retained only for a defined business or legal purpose.

3.1 Retention schedule

Record type	Retention	Owner
Routine team notes	1 year	Team owner
Customer support record	3 years	Support Operations
Security incident record	7 years	Cybersecurity
Approved policy	Current plus 3 prior versions	Policy owner

3.2 Common scenarios

- A support engineer may download an Internal manual to a managed laptop.
- A contractor may not open a Restricted incident record without explicit assignment.
- A manager may share a Confidential contract with named Legal reviewers.
- A remote employee must report a lost managed laptop immediately.

3.3 Reporting concerns

Report suspected data leakage, incorrect sharing permissions, or lost equipment through the Service Desk. Urgent security concerns should also be escalated to Cybersecurity.

RAG test ideas: Use this file for classification, retention, cross-policy retrieval, and access-control questions.